



Global pop

Korean pop (or K-pop) music has become hugely popular worldwide, with bands such as BTS (above) selling millions of singles and albums.

Delicious dish

The popular South Korean dish bibimbap is a mix of rice, vegetables, meat, and egg. It originated in the 15th century.



Lotus vase

Korea has a tradition of fine pottery and porcelain. Much was produced during the Goryeo Dynasty (918–1392 CE), including this ornate vase featuring a lotus flower.

Fighters must strike the colored areas of their opponent's body or head protector to score points.



Tae Kwon Do

The national sport of South Korea is Tae Kwon Do. Competitors are allowed to use both their hands and feet during matches. This ancient martial art was invented to help soldiers prepare for battle.

South Korea



Asia

Sejong the Great

One of the most revered figures in Korean history, King Sejongdaewang was a brilliant scholar who ruled the nation in the 15th century.



The Hangeul alphabet was introduced by King Sejongdaewang.



Ulleung-do

Hats worn by military musicians are often decorated with bird feathers.



Hallasan
1,947 m
(6,388 ft)

0 50 km
0 50 miles
(approximate scale)

Marching music

Daechwita is a traditional form of military marching music that uses instruments such as drums, brass horns, and gongs. It accompanies the ceremonial changing of the guards at the country's royal palaces.

A yonggo is a barrel drum decorated with painted dragons.



- 38,502 sq miles (99,720 sq km)
- 51.8 million
- Seoul
- Korean

On the bottom half of a peninsula jutting out between the **Sea of Japan** and the **Yellow Sea**, South Korea is **one of Asia's biggest economies**, with booming businesses in **electronics** and **car manufacturing**.